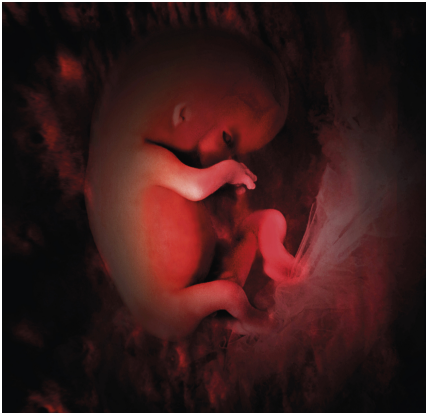




YOU ARE **10 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
209 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this side view of a fetus, the right ear and eye are just visible and the right hand and leg can be seen in characteristically bent positions. The reddish, tubelike structure, to the right of the image, is the umbilical cord.

“Your prenatal care begins with your first appointment, where you will get to talk with your ob/gyn about your pregnancy care.”

You should have your first prenatal appointment around now. The exact timing of it will vary depending on when your doctor sees pregnant patients for the first time. This is the first time you will see your ob/gyn during pregnancy. Unless your doctor has a solo practice (see [Prenatal care options](#)), your prenatal team is likely to consist of several doctors who will take care of you throughout your pregnancy.

The purpose of this appointment is for a doctor to obtain your medical history, provide information, and plan your care for pregnancy and the birth. It's also an opportunity for you to ask any questions you may have and discuss the schedule for appointments, blood tests, scans, and prenatal classes. You will be given booklets, information leaflets, and important contact telephone numbers.

The doctor will ask you about your medical history; your family's medical history; your partner and your partner's family's medical history; about any previous pregnancies you have had; and how this pregnancy has been so far.

Your answers will help the doctor identify factors that may affect your pregnancy, for example, if there is a family history of preeclampsia. The doctor will also do some health tests, such as urine tests, at this and other prenatal appointments.

THE ROLE OF A MIDWIFE

Midwife comes from the anglo-saxon word “mit wif,” meaning “with woman.” A midwife's role is to respect the ability of a woman to give birth independently, and to only intervene when it is essential to do so.

ASK A DOCTOR

How should I decide which tests I want? Your doctor will give you a lot of information regarding tests, and you have to decide whether you want them. There are two different types: screening tests (see [Tests for chromosomal abnormalities](#)) and [diagnostic tests](#). The goal of screening tests is to figure out the risk of there being a problem—based on the result, you may be advised to have a diagnostic test.